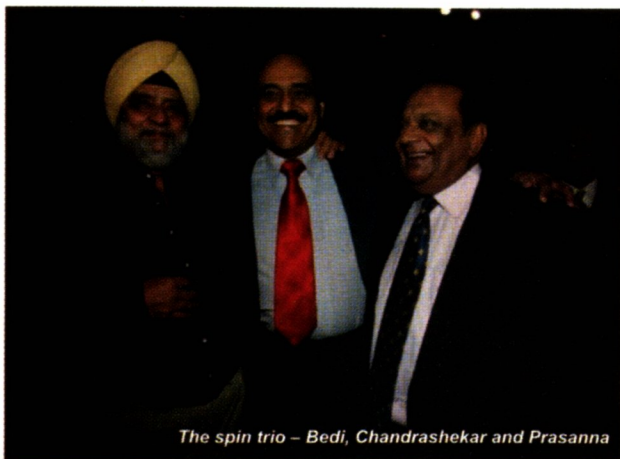




The spin trio – Bedi, Chandrashekar and Prasanna

cricketers who were thrilled to be sharing the spotlight with their heroes. Whilst Sachin Tendulkar recounted how Bishen Bedi made them run six rounds if the ball was lifted in the air during practice, Rahul Dravid spoke about his coach, the Late Keki Tarapore, who emphasized the importance of playing shots in the 'V'. Prasanna and Bedi both talked about the role played by their captain MAK Pataudi with Bedi saying that Pataudi was the first captain who ensured that India played like Team India and not as players from various States.

Over the years, the Castrol Awards have evolved not only numerically, but also in stature. Through their consistency, transparency and quantitative as well as qualitative evaluation method, they have established themselves as the 'definitive' awards in Indian cricket. Starting off with just one Award



Nari Contractor



Sourav Ganguly receiving the most successful Captain Award



Chandra Nayudu

"My father would have loved T20 cricket. He would have scored a four and a six every over."

Chandra Nayudu (who accepted the Castrol Outstanding Cricketer of the Era on behalf of her father the Late C K Nayudu)

– the Castrol Indian Cricketer of the Year – the Awards have been expanded over the years to include various other categories – the Castrol Lifetime Achievement Award, the Castrol Junior Cricketer of the Year Award, the Castrol Outstanding Achievement Awards and Awards for the Best Batting, Bowling and Fielding Performances. At the Awards function in Kochi, Castrol announced yet another category – The Castrol Cricketing Awards for Women which will be given away from 2008 onwards.

This year marks the 10th Anniversary of the Castrol Awards for Cricketing Excellence and the occasion happily coincided with the 75th Anniversary of Indian Test Cricket, It was therefore befitting that this year's Awards focused on recognizing and felicitating cricketers and captains who had played for India over the last 75 years. The period was divided into six eras and the most outstanding cricketers of each era were honoured and felicitated.

"I still remember Vinoo telling me as we were walking out to bat, 'dikra ball male etle ke de!'" (As soon as you get the ball, just smash it!)

Nari Contractor

Through the years : The Castrol Outstanding Cricketers

The early years :	1932 – 1947 C K Nayudu
The first whiff of Victory :	1947 – 1961 Vinoo Mankad
The eye of the Tiger :	1961 – 1971 MAK Pataudi
Sunny Days :	1971 – 1981 Sunil Gavaskar
The Hurricane & the Boy :	1981 – 1997 Kapil Dev
The Castrol Era :	1997 - 2007 Sachin Tendulkar and Rahul Dravid

Also felicitated were the Indian Test Captains through the years, who were present on the occasion. Sourav Ganguly was adjudged India's most Successful Captain.

The Castrol Awards for Cricketing Excellence have come of age and are here to stay – celebrating the spirit of Indian cricket – past, present and future.